

4-Hour SLA Escalation Playbook

Keep customer-impacting work on a clear path before the 4-hour response commitment expires.

Audience	Support leads and incident coordinators
Prerequisites	Ticket has a timestamp, owner, customer impact statement, and severity
Last reviewed	2026-08-04

Procedure

1. At 0-30 minutes, acknowledge impact and set the next update time.
2. At 30-120 minutes, collect reproduction details and link relevant known issues.
3. At 120 minutes, notify the support lead if no durable workaround is documented.
4. At 180 minutes, page the engineering liaison with ticket summary, impact, and requested decision.
5. Before 4 hours, send the customer an explicit status, workaround or containment, and next checkpoint.

Warnings

Warning: A status update is not a resolution; retain ownership until a verified next action exists.

Warning: Do not promise a fix date unless Engineering has approved it.

Escalation boundary

Escalate immediately for widespread outage, data integrity risk, or any ticket that cannot receive a meaningful update before the 4-hour mark.

Synthetic example

Example: HD-3821 reaches 180 minutes with a blocked export; the lead pages the liaison and references KI-1051.

Internal operational guidance. Examples, names, IDs, and account details are synthetic.